[HIST-ORAL-001] Oral Tradition of the Elder Brother and Younger Brother

Translation / Context: Narrative of Fraternal Kinship Between Hills and Valley

Category: ORAL_HISTORY | Period: Traditional Oral Era | Date: Ancestral Era
Place: Hundung / Valley [Hundung] | Dialect: Standard Tangkhul
Source: Documented in Horam 1977, Hodson 1911 (1500)
Clearance: Oral Heritage | Permission: community_authorized | Status: verified

---

Key Figures: Elder Brother (Hill Forefather), Younger Brother (Valley Forefather), Cultural Custodians

Topography: Ukhrul Hills and Manipur Valley (Kangla)

Overview: Widespread traditional narrative recounting common ancestry where the elder brother remained in the mountainous hills (Tangkhul) while the younger brother migrated to settle the valley (Meitei).

Indigenous Tangkhul Chronicle / Oral Memory:

Tangkhul oral tradition-li elder brother kala younger brother-wui frater
Elder brother-na high cold mountains (Ukhrul hills)-li pama, younger bro
Annual Mera Houchongba festival-li hill and valley brothers exchange gif

---

English Translation & Scholarly Interpretation:

The timeless Tangkhul oral tradition recounts the fraternal narrative of
The elder brother made his home in the rugged, forested hills (Tangkhul)
This fraternal bond is celebrated annually during the Mera Houchongba fe

---

Chronological Milestones & Key Events:

1. Primordial Era: Common ancestors dwell together before parting peacefully from the ancestral hearth.
2. Mountain and Valley: Elder brother establishes terrace farming in the hills; younger brother develops valley agriculture.
3. Traditional Pacts: Annual winter gatherings established for exchanging forest produce (chillies, cotton, pottery) for valley salt
4. Mera Houchongba Festival: Formalized under the Manipur monarchy in October to celebrate this sacred kinship.

Key Tangkhul Historical Terminology:

* Ite-Inao : Elder brother and younger brother kinship relation
* Mera Houchongba : Festival of hill-valley solidarity celebrated in a
* Ngarum-Chon : Ceremonial shawl woven to commemorate brotherhood

---